Most Influential People in Computer Science

Author : Juan Rinconada **Date :** Sep 6, 2019

Introduction

The history of computer science is full of men and women from different fields that have contributed to the era of information as we know it. This list provides an overview of the achievements of some of the most influential figures in computer science.

The Pioneers

Al-Khwarizmi (780) - A Persian scholar who contributed significantly to algebra and introduced the term 'Algorithm'.

Blaise Pascal (1623) - Built the Pascaline, an early mechanical calculator, and contributed to mathematics and physics.

Charles Babbage (1791) - Designed the analytical engine, a precursor to the modern computer.

The Ones with the Theory

George Boole (1815) - Developed Boolean algebra, foundational for digital logic.

John von Neumann (1940) - Defined modern computer architecture.

Alan Turing (1951) - Broke the Enigma machine code and introduced the Turing machine.

Claude Shannon (1963) - Founded information theory and contributed to cryptanalysis.

The Women

Ada Lovelace (1840) - Considered the first computer programmer.

Grace Hopper (1984) - Developed COBOL and contributed to programming language advancements.

Margaret Hamilton (1969) - Led software development for the Apollo missions.

Barbara Liskov (2016) - Known for the Liskov Substitution Principle and contributions to distributed computing.